

第壹部分、選擇題 (占 62 分)

一、詞彙題 (占 10 分)

說明：第 1 題至第 10 題為單選題，每題 1 分。

1. Having enough \_\_\_\_\_ is essential for maintaining a healthy balance between professional responsibilities and personal well-being in today's fast-paced society.  
D (A) certificate 文件 (B) vacancy (C) leisure 休閒 (D) discount 折扣
2. Without finding a warm shelter, stray animals can easily \_\_\_\_\_ to death during a severe winter blizzard.  
B (A) blink (B) freeze (C) proceed (D) migrate
3. The kindergarten teacher's \_\_\_\_\_ voice quickly calmed the frightened child and stopped him from crying.  
A (A) tender 溫柔的 (B) moral 道德 (C) stingy 小氣的 (D) fragile
4. The strong earthquake cracked the \_\_\_\_\_, which made it dangerous for both vehicles and pedestrians.  
B (A) fragment (B) pavement (C) investment (D) equipment
5. The basketball player \_\_\_\_\_ went past several defenders before scoring the winning basket in the final seconds of the game.  
V (A) superficially (B) delicately (C) passively (D) skillfully
6. You should be careful not to \_\_\_\_\_ your coworkers by making jokes about sensitive topics during team meetings or company events.  
V (A) amend (B) expose (C) isolate (D) offend
7. The \_\_\_\_\_ treatment of the prisoners shocked the public and led several human rights organizations to demand an immediate investigation.  
A (A) brutal (B) coarse (C) furious (D) thorough
8. The company made several \_\_\_\_\_ to its business strategy after realizing that consumer preferences had changed significantly over the past few years.  
A (A) alternatives (B) applications (C) adjustments (D) authorities
9. Although talent is important, it alone does not \_\_\_\_\_ a successful career without continuous effort.  
B (A) dominate (B) guarantee (C) reassure (D) lecture
10. After staying up all night to study, Linda felt so \_\_\_\_\_ in class that she could barely keep her eyes open while taking the test.  
A (A) drowsy (B) critical (C) flexible (D) glorious

第 11 至 15 題為題組

Anyone working in the publishing business is likely to come across *lorem ipsum*. It is scrambled Latin text traditionally used as a placeholder to check the appearance of text on pages in a book or on a website. Designers use lorem ipsum to test the layout and design of a product before it is printed. It helps printers \_\_\_11\_\_\_ such as text size, font, color, and word spacing without getting distracted by the meaning or message of the text.

At first glance, lorem ipsum looks like a \_\_\_12\_\_\_ passage written in Latin. However, the text is actually meaningless. It originated from a speech by a Roman politician and philosopher named Cicero, but the words and grammar \_\_\_13\_\_\_ to create a text with no real meaning. Some scholars believe Cicero's speech was first adapted by a printing house in the 1500s, although not everyone agrees. Others argue that historical evidence \_\_\_14\_\_\_ a later origin, possibly in the early 1900s.

What we do know is that lorem ipsum came into widespread use in the 1960s. \_\_\_15\_\_\_ computers in the late 20th century, the text was included in many printing software programs. In the 21st century, it has become the standard filler text for publishers and continues to serve as a useful tool for designers.

11. (A) translate articles (B) collect samples (C) arrange patterns (D) evaluate factors  
12. (A) genuine (B) messy (C) furious (D) steady  
13. (A) had been altered (B) have been altering (C) were altered (D) would alter  
14. (A) stems from (B) points to (C) comes with (D) takes on  
15. (A) On behalf of (B) In place of (C) With the rise of (D) For the purpose of

第 16 至 20 題為題組

In 2024, Taiwan won the WBSC Premier12 title by defeating the top-ranked Japanese team. This was a major historic achievement, not only for the team but also for the legacy of baseball in Taiwan.

Baseball was first introduced to Taiwan during the Japanese colonial period. In 1931, a team from Taiwan reached the final of Japan's national high school baseball tournament and \_\_\_16\_\_\_ in second place. After World War II, school teams and local leagues \_\_\_17\_\_\_ across the island as public interest in the sport grew.

In 1969, Taiwan \_\_\_18\_\_\_ on the international baseball scene by winning the Little League World Series for the first time. Throughout the 1970s, Taiwan won the Little League, Junior League, and Senior League Baseball World Championship titles in the same year multiple times. The 1980s are remembered as a golden era of baseball for Taiwan, \_\_\_19\_\_\_ Taiwan enjoyed remarkable success in international competitions.

The Chinese Professional Baseball League (CPBL) was founded in 1989 and held its inaugural game the following year. The league started out with only four teams, but now it has six. With cheerleaders, team chants, songs, and dances creating \_\_\_20\_\_\_, the CPBL keeps the sport exciting and innovative. The 2024 Premier12 triumph reflected the passion and commitment that have driven baseball in Taiwan for generations.

- C A 16. (A) earned (B) arrived (C) finished (D) closed  
A C 17. (A) sprang up (B) passed out (C) moved on (D) gave in  
D W 18. (A) took the roll (B) hung its head (C) faced the music (D) made its mark  
B C 19. (A) where (B) during which (C) there (D) in that  
- 20. (A) an unusual opportunity (B) a cultural background  
(C) an infamous reputation (D) a lively atmosphere

### 三、文意選填 (占 10 分)

說明：第 21 題至第 30 題為單選題，每題 1 分。

#### 第 21 至 30 題為題組

The internet has given people instant access to an enormous amount of knowledge and media. Although this offers many advantages, it has also given rise to \_\_21\_\_ consequences. One growing problem is information overload, often called “infobesity.” This term describes the habit of taking in far more information than the human mind can comfortably process. Such a habit can leave people mentally \_\_22\_\_ after spending even a short time online.

Infobesity appears in different ways and influences many areas of daily life. In the workplace, managers and employees may find it difficult to make sound decisions when they are presented with too much information. Younger generations are especially \_\_23\_\_ to information overload because of social media. Many teenagers receive a constant stream of notifications from multiple apps throughout the day. As a result, they often feel pressured to check their phones repeatedly for fear of missing important \_\_24\_\_ or social interactions. Online consumers also experience this issue. When shoppers are faced with countless reviews, advertisements, and product options, even buying ordinary items can become \_\_25\_\_ or overwhelming.

Another major concern is the effect of information overload on \_\_26\_\_. Research conducted by Microsoft found that the average person in Canada now spends fewer than 10 seconds focusing on a piece of digital content before \_\_27\_\_ something else. This trend suggests that constant exposure to large amounts of information may gradually weaken people’s ability to maintain attention for long periods of time.

Although there is no simple \_\_28\_\_ for infobesity, several practical strategies may reduce its impact. One effective approach is to limit the number of information sources people rely on each day. People can reduce mental strain by \_\_29\_\_ time to focus on topics that are truly meaningful. In addition, limiting cellphone use and taking regular \_\_30\_\_ from social media may improve both attention and emotional well-being. Ironically, while technology has brought about this modern problem, future technological tools may eventually help people manage information in healthier and more balanced ways.

- |                  |            |                |                   |                   |
|------------------|------------|----------------|-------------------|-------------------|
| (A) stressful    | (B) cure   | (C) updates    | (D) setting aside | (E) exhausted     |
| (F) switching to | (G) breaks | (H) unintended | (I) prone         | (J) concentration |

答案：21. (H) 22. (E) 23. (I) 24. (C) 25. (A)  
26. (J) 27. (F) 28. (B) 29. (V) 30. (G)

第 31 至 34 題為題組

When we think of carbon emissions, fashion may not be the first thing that comes to mind. However, the fashion industry is expected to account for a growing share of global carbon emissions in the coming decades. \_\_31\_\_

With this in mind, fashion designers have started searching for more environmentally friendly materials to create fashion that can be sustainable in the long term. \_\_32\_\_ They can be made from food scraps that would otherwise end up in incinerators or landfills.

Besides peels, seeds and other parts of fruits can also be used to create fashion materials. Some of these can be made into leather alternatives that are biodegradable, long-lasting, and cruelty-free. Pineapple leather, for example, is made from fibers extracted from pineapple leaves. \_\_33\_\_ Even sofas, chairs, and car interiors can also be made with pineapple leather. Another example is apple leather, which is made from leftover apple pulp, peels, and cores and has a feel very similar to real animal leather.

\_\_34\_\_ Dense and fibrous mushroom-based materials can be grown by carefully controlling the humidity, temperature, and CO<sub>2</sub> levels. Once they reach the desired size, the materials are harvested and treated with special chemicals. As an added benefit, the chemicals required for this process are less harmful than those used for animal leather.

Recently, an Australian company has started to create a wool-like fabric from coconuts called Nullarbor. This process does not require cutting down trees and uses very little water and land, emphasizing the benefits of plant-based materials.

- (A) It has been used to make jackets, shoes, and bags.
- (B) Pineapple plants are widely grown in tropical regions around the world.
- (C) In addition, mushrooms can also be used as a great substitute for animal leather.
- (D) Among the many alternatives being explored, plant-based fabrics may have the greatest potential.
- (E) One reason is that every second, the equivalent of one garbage truck of clothing is thrown away or burned.

答案：31. (E) 32. (A) 33. (B) 34. (C)

五、閱讀測驗（占 24 分）

說明：第 35 題至第 46 題為單選題，每題 2 分。

第 35 至 38 題為題組

Imagine a world before standardized time. Many cities around the world had their own way of telling time based on the position of the Sun. Sundials were among the earliest clocks created for this purpose. Analog clocks were invented later, making time easier to tell, but they did not solve the problem of time being **relative**. There was also no fixed standard for the start or end of a day. As travel became more common, coordinating schedules between different places became increasingly difficult.

One solution proposed by scientists to create a standard time was Greenwich Mean Time (GMT). GMT was originally based on the mean solar time at the Prime Meridian, an imaginary line connecting the North and South Poles that divides the Earth into the Eastern and Western Hemispheres. Observations of the Sun were traditionally made at the Royal Observatory in Greenwich, England. When the Sun reached its

highest point in the sky above Greenwich, it was considered noon there. This method was by no means new, as sailors from Britain had been using it since the 18th century. To determine their longitude at sea, they carried mechanical clocks set to Greenwich time and compared the readings with local solar time.

With the growth of Britain's transport and communication networks, GMT gradually became the national standard time. This shift was reinforced by the fact that, by the late 19th century, about 72% of the world's shipping used charts based on the Greenwich meridian. Even today, many time zones are still expressed in relation to GMT. For example, traveling east from England, which is GMT+0, might put one in a GMT+3 time zone, meaning the local time is three hours ahead. In contrast, traveling west might place one in a GMT-3 time zone, where the local time is three hours behind Greenwich time.

However, as the Earth's rotation is not perfectly uniform, GMT is less precise. Many countries now use Coordinated Universal Time (UTC), which relies on atomic clocks for greater accuracy.

35. Which of the following statements about time-measuring tools is true?

- (A) British sailors used a standard clock and local time measurement to navigate.
- (B) Atomic clocks determine time according to the Sun's position over Greenwich.
- (C) The invention of analog clocks eliminated the need for a universal time standard.
- (D) Sundials were the first devices that helped establish a worldwide standard time system.

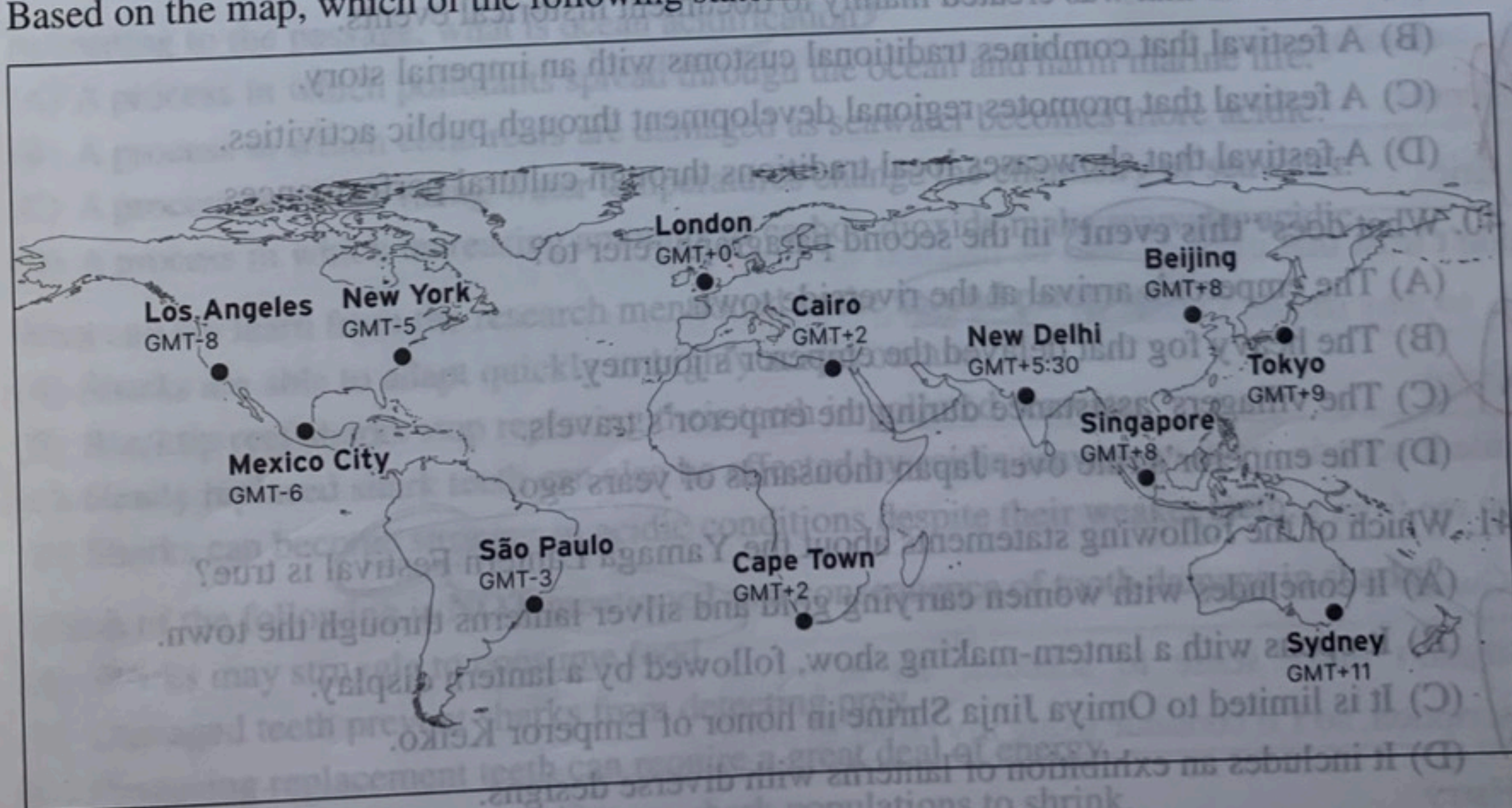
36. What does the author mean by "relative" in the first paragraph?

- (A) Difficult for people to understand.
- (B) Connected to family relationships.
- (C) Measured with complete accuracy.
- (D) Dependent on a particular location.

37. Which of the following is true according to the passage?

- (A) Most countries continued to rely on local solar time after GMT was introduced.
- (B) Advances in transportation reduced the need for a shared time standard.
- (C) GMT gained international influence partly through its widespread use in navigation.
- (D) Standardized time systems were created to improve scientific observation of the Sun.

38. Based on the map, which of the following statements is true?



- (A) Cities located in the same country share the same GMT time zone.
- (B) The local time in Tokyo is later than that in Mexico City.
- (C) London has an earlier local time than New York.
- (D) Sydney has an earlier local time than Cairo.

第 39 至 42 題為題組

Summer in Japan is a season of fireworks and celebrations. As the days grow long, hot, and humid, temples across the country host vibrant festivals. Each one carries a unique origin story that reflects local history and traditions. Among the most celebrated is the Yamaga Lantern Festival in Kumamoto Prefecture in southern Japan.

The Yamaga Lantern Festival is held in the middle of August and honors a legendary emperor who ruled over Japan thousands of years ago. The story goes that Emperor Keiko was traveling along the Kikuchi River with his court when a heavy fog rolled in, making it difficult for the emperor to continue his journey. The local villagers lit torches to help him safely travel through the area. Today, the lantern festival serves as a tribute to **this event**.

Traditional lanterns, called "toro" in Japanese, play a significant role during the festival. Visitors will find many elaborate paper lanterns made of traditional washi paper. They come in a variety of shapes, such as castles, shrines, and even dolls. On the first night of the festival, all the new lanterns are brought out and put on display. A special toro dance is performed at Omiya Jinja Shrine, with the evening ending in a fireworks display over the nearby river. On the second night, a torchlit parade travels through the town, recalling the emperor's journey long ago. At the end of the parade, roughly 1,000 female dancers wearing gold and silver lanterns on their heads perform a traditional dance.

While the Yamaga Lantern Festival lasts only two nights each August, visitors can learn about the festival and its history all year round at the Yamaga Lantern Folk Art Museum. Here, people find information about the traditional craft of making toro lanterns and can discover artifacts from previous lantern festivals.

39. What is this passage mainly about?

(A) A festival that was created mainly to document historical events.

(B) A festival that combines traditional customs with an imperial story.

(C) A festival that promotes regional development through public activities.

(D) A festival that showcases local traditions through cultural performances.

40. What does "**this event**" in the second paragraph refer to?

(A) The emperor's arrival at the riverside town.

(B) The heavy fog that delayed the emperor's journey.

(C) The villagers' assistance during the emperor's travels.

(D) The emperor's rule over Japan thousands of years ago.

41. Which of the following statements about the Yamaga Lantern Festival is true?

(A) It concludes with women carrying gold and silver lanterns through the town.

(B) It opens with a lantern-making show, followed by a lantern display.

(C) It is limited to Omiya Jinja Shrine in honor of Emperor Keiko.

(D) It includes an exhibition of lanterns with diverse designs.

42. Mike is planning to visit Kumamoto Prefecture next April. What can he do there?

(A) Watch a fireworks display every night.

(B) Take part in a parade that passes through town.

(C) View artifacts from past festivals in a local museum.

(D) Attend a traditional dance performance during the festival.

Over the past century, industrialization has profoundly reshaped our planet. While experts may debate the details, some consequences are undeniable, such as global climate change, widespread pollution, and the loss of natural habitats. One effect still under study is ocean acidification, a process in which seawater absorbs excess carbon dioxide, causing pH levels to fall and acidity to rise. This chemical shift is already disrupting marine ecosystems, putting coral reefs, shellfish, and many other marine organisms at risk.

One animal negatively affected by ocean acidification is the shark. Recent research suggests that acidic seawater can weaken shark teeth, despite how strong they might look. In one experiment, researchers tested naturally shed teeth from blacktip reef sharks by placing them in seawater with different pH levels. In the more acidic water, the teeth developed visible cracks, holes, and root corrosion. Although sharks continuously replace their teeth, prolonged exposure to acidified water could also put the new teeth at risk.

Damaged teeth directly affect a shark's ability to feed. Weaker, more brittle teeth reduce efficiency in catching and consuming prey. This, in turn, makes their survival more difficult. Furthermore, the process of regrowing teeth requires a significant amount of energy. In acidified waters, the cost of constant repair may be unsustainable. As these challenges accumulate, shark populations could decline, especially among species with slower tooth replacement cycles. If sharks struggle to feed, their health, reproduction, and population stability will suffer, weakening their role as top predators.

Sharks are keystone species in marine ecosystems. By regulating prey populations, they maintain balance in food webs and prevent overpopulation of smaller fish. If shark populations decline due to tooth erosion and feeding difficulties, entire ecosystems could become unstable, leading to serious effects on biodiversity. Protecting sharks means addressing the root cause, one of which is reducing carbon emissions to slow ocean acidification. Shark conservation is not just about preserving one species; it is about maintaining the health of the entire ocean.

43. According to the passage, what is ocean acidification?

- (A) A process in which pollutants spread through the ocean and harm marine life.
- (B) A process in which coral reefs are damaged as seawater becomes more acidic.
- (C) A process in which rising water temperatures change the chemistry of seawater.
- (D) A process in which increasing amounts of carbon dioxide make seawater acidic.

44. What can we learn from the research mentioned in the second paragraph?

- (A) Sharks are able to adapt quickly to highly acidic oceans.
- (B) Blacktip reef sharks stop replacing their teeth in polluted seawater.
- (C) Newly replaced shark teeth can also be affected by acidic seawater.
- (D) Sharks can become stronger in acidic conditions despite their weaker teeth.

45. Which of the following is **NOT** mentioned as a consequence of tooth damage in sharks?

- (A) Sharks may struggle to consume food.
- (B) Damaged teeth prevent sharks from detecting prey.
- (C) Producing replacement teeth can require a great deal of energy.
- (D) Long-term tooth damage may cause shark populations to shrink.

46. According to the passage, how do sharks contribute to healthy marine ecosystems?

- (A) By reducing the amount of carbon dioxide in the ocean.
- (B) By controlling the numbers of some marine animals.
- (C) By providing shelter for smaller marine animals.
- (D) By filtering harmful substances from seawater.